

Unequal access by design

Industrial zoning and spatial justice in
Seattle's Lower Duwamish corridor

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RESEARCH QUESTION

**How does industrial land use shape everyday access
in Georgetown and South Park?**

Planning justice asks who benefits

An equity lens for evaluating the distribution of usable urban resources

Equity

Who can use the
resources of the city?

Material well-being

How do decisions relate
to everyday needs?

Diversity

Whose needs enter
planning assessment?

Application to this case: assess access alongside industrial land designation.

Interpretive lens introduced here; the abstract does not report applying this framework.

Access emerges from land use and networks

Relate land-use decisions to destinations, connections, and service timing

Integrated planning

Waddell · UrbanSim

Land use + transportation
+ public policy

Network accessibility

Blanchard & Waddell · UrbanAccess

Walking + operational
transit networks

CASE-SPECIFIC TASK

**Relate industrial designation to usable resources
and community accounts of access.**

These are framing approaches; neither model is reported as used in this study.

Cleanup and public access are planning questions



Studio context map · not zoning boundaries

5-mile waterway

EPA's Superfund site extent; separate from neighborhood zoning shares.

■ 2001

National Priorities List

Lower Duwamish site added

■ 2014

Cleanup plan selected

EPA selects the site remedy

■ SUMMER 2022

Duwamish River People's Park

Opens; EPA describes habitat restoration and increased public river access

Milestones provide context; they do not establish corridor-wide access outcomes.

Connect spatial patterns with community input

Read spatial conditions and household context alongside lived experience

Spatial patterns

MUNICIPAL DATA + GIS

Zoning + public and
environmental resources

Household context

AMERICAN COMMUNITY SURVEY

Socioeconomic conditions
across the two neighborhoods

Community input

TEAM-COMMUNITY WORKSHOP

Experiences of mobility,
resources, and participation

Approximate study period: 2023–2025

Dataset vintages, access measures, and workshop participation details are not supplied.

Industrial designation concentrates across both neighborhoods

Reported land share designated for maritime manufacturing and logistics



Concentration establishes the setting for an access inquiry.

Access constraints span mobility, space, and resources

The abstract reports several connected dimensions of everyday access

Mobility

Fragmented mobility networks

Public space

Limited public green space

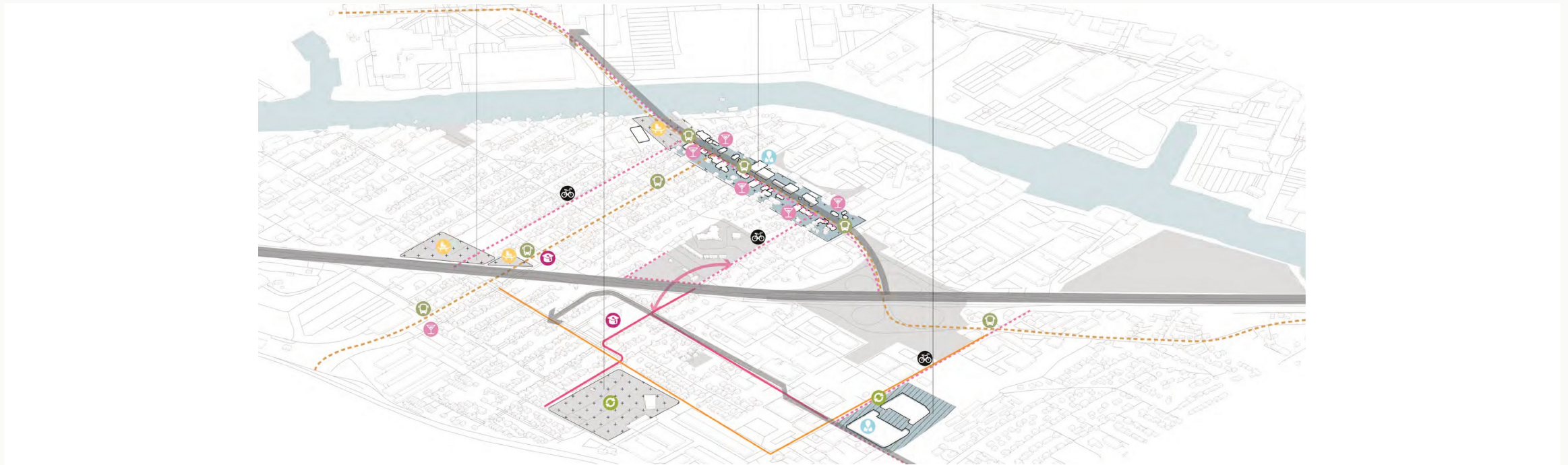
Environmental resources

Reduced environmental amenities

Household context: both neighborhoods' median incomes are reported below the King County average.

Studio illustration: a four-site service network

Proposed links among community services and destinations



South Park

Marra Farm

**Duwamish River
Community Hub**

Food Lifeline

Studio illustration: Food Lifeline's public interface



1 Entry plaza

Events + café

2 Pedestrian edge

Movement + urban farm

3 Loading areas

Operational functions

Test usefulness, circulation,
and responsibilities with users.

Make access a criterion of industrial planning

Connect industrial land decisions to everyday resources and responsibilities

Knowledge

Connect industrial designation with multidimensional accounts of access.

Practice

Use access audits in land-use and infrastructure decisions.

Pedagogy

Use studio drawings to formulate and test planning questions.

From a corridor case to a research agenda

Questions for comparative and longitudinal work

- 1 How does industrial designation relate to access across households and networks?**
- 2 Whose experiences do mapped indicators miss?**
- 3 Which decisions expand resources without shifting burdens?**

Next evidence: defined boundaries · dated datasets · access measures · documented community input

References

PLANNING LITERATURE

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OFFICIAL CONTEXT + AUTHOR DOCUMENTATION

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[5] Urban Data Science Toolkit. (n.d.). History of UrbanSim and UDST. Original author documentation.

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PRIMARY MATERIALS

Author/date unstated. *Unequal Access by Design: Industrial Zoning and Spatial Justice in Seattle’s Lower Duwamish Corridor*. Supplied abstract: ACSP.pdf, p. 1.

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